

You want your music to be enjoyable to listen to, regardless of the genre it falls under. You want other people to take pleasure in listening to your tracks, to be able to understand the message, and to not be distracted by a poor recording or weak playing. There are an infinite number of ways to put together your masterpiece, and it is incredibly simple to mess it up. Imagine yourself as a chef with a kitchen full of ingredients.

It is my hope that by the end of this column, you will have a better understanding of the entire process of making music, from start to finish, and will be able to produce tracks that are up to the level of quality that we refer to as “good music,” regardless of the genre. With each piece, I’ll do my best to present you with fresh ways of considering how you approach the process of composing music, which you are free to put into practise in any way that you see fit. The main thing is that you have a solid understanding of the procedure and the tools that are at your disposal. This will make it much simpler for you to produce a high-quality track that conveys your message in the way that you planned.

To begin, let’s begin by describing the process of music production by breaking it down into its six fundamental stages:

- Songwriting
- Arranging
- Tracking
- Editing
- Mixing
- Mastering

These are not in any way fixed in stone, you might come up with your own technique. The purpose of the breakdown is to provide a broad guideline that may be utilised to assist in organising the process in our heads. We frequently perform several of these at the same time (e.g. songwriting and arranging, tracking and editing and mixing, etc.). It is helpful to understand what goes into each stage so that we can carry it out correctly and obtain the greatest results. These are the general processes that are performed to generate a track, whether consciously or not. But these are the steps that are taken on average.

Songwriting

What does it even mean to write a song in this day and age when the majority of popular music does not contain lyrics? This is a fantastic question that should be covered in another article. Let’s say, however, that for the purposes of our discussion, songwriting is the process of putting musical ideas together